



1-26-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4EtCp3IFzTI
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or separate committee work session was held prior to the call to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees was called to order by the presiding officer, opening with a moment of silence in memory of Russell Robinson, a former South Side educator who passed away recently, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Heater, Mrs. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Erwin, and Mr. Lowe.
 - **Members Absent:** (Not explicitly specified in roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified through proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** A moment of silence was observed for Russell Robinson. The Pledge of Allegiance was led virtually by student representatives.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Prior meeting minutes were not explicitly addressed in the provided transcript text).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:41 Presentation: Longfellow Elementary School Accomplishments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gary Moore, Principal of Longfellow Elementary School, joined by staff members (including master teacher Faith Surf and third-grade teacher Mrs. Cummings via video).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Moore presented key achievements and initiatives at Longfellow Elementary under the motto "Excellence is the expectation<U+2014>excellence with no excuses." Highlights included:
 - Implementation of Project Lead The Way (PLTW) and the "Promise, Partnership, and Potential" (MP3) extended-day program, boasting a 92% pass rate on IREAD over the last eight years.
 - Literacy and math growth, showing significant reduction in at-risk student percentages via I-Ready diagnostics.
 - Social-Emotional Learning (SEL) utilizing Second Step and Ripple Effects, which contributed to slashing office referrals from 548 (2019<U+2013>20) to 214, alongside decreased suspensions.
 - Overhauling lesson planning through four key components: learning objectives ("I can" statements), student work exemplars, and success criteria.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal board action required.
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00:03:02 Presentation: Central High School Student Advisory Board Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Student Advisory Board members (Mackenzie, Brooke Stallings, Josie, and Emma Ambler) accompanied by staff advisor Ms. Snyder.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Students presented several proposals and operational feedback:
 - **Block Scheduling:** Evaluated the current 7-period block schedule and advocated for a transition to an 8-block schedule to reduce teacher and student fatigue, expand electives, and improve student focus.

- **Latin Honors:** Proposed replacing traditional Valedictorian/Salutatorian rankings with a Latin Honors system (Summa Cum Laude, Magna Cum Laude, Cum Laude) to reduce toxic competition and encourage holistic course selection.
 - **Adulting & Sensitivity Training:** Suggested monthly 20-to-30-minute sessions during lunch/homerooms to teach practical life skills (taxes, FAFSA, checkbooks) and peer mental health support.
 - **Recycling Initiative:** Proposed expanding recycling programs into elementary schools with friendly competitions, blue bags, and collaboration with the Muncie Sanitary District and city council climate resolutions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; referred to administration for review.
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00:02:21 Presentation: Success Academy <U+2013> Middle School Alternative Education Program

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bob Hatfield (District Psychologist), Shelby Pavelka, and Deidre Bibbs (School Psychology Extern).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The presenters introduced the "Success Academy," a redesigned alternative education program for North Side and South Side middle schools.
 - Addressed historical flaws of previous alternative education models, which functioned as unappealing "dumping grounds" with a single-teacher model unable to meet diverse academic and emotional needs.
 - The new Success Academy framework features targeted academic instruction in the mornings, built-in Social-Emotional Learning (SEL) in the afternoons, project-based community involvement, a transparent point/level system, and clear criteria for entering and successfully reintegrating back into general education.
 - A pilot program is currently underway at South Side Middle School, with a formal district-wide rollout planned for Fall 2021.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; received with high praise from board members.
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01:32:42 Action Item: 2021<U+2013>2022 Muncie Community Schools High School Curriculum Handbook

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Chuck Reynolds.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the high school curriculum handbook for the 2021<U+2013>2022 school year, featuring updated course numbers per the IDOE, the

revised Indiana Certificate of Completion, newly added courses, and updated career center offerings reflecting new partnerships.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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01:35:56 Action Item: 2021<U+2013>2022 Middle School Course of Study Handbook

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Chuck Reynolds / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the middle school course of study handbook for the 2021<U+2013>2022 school year with minimal changes, highlighting the expansion of Project Lead The Way for all middle schoolers and high-school credit-earning opportunities in Spanish and Preparing for College and Careers.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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01:34:56 Action Item: Cancellation of Outstanding Checks

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Business/Finance Staff (Mr. Jerome).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for authorization to void outstanding checks older than two years (as of December 31, 2020) and revert those funds back into the school corporation's accounts. Administration confirmed attempts were made to contact payees before bringing the item forward.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:32:24 Representative from YWCA Central Indiana:** Addressed the board to express gratitude to Dr. Kwiatkowski and the MCS staff for providing generous donations, gift cards, and Christmas gifts for residents, women, and children at the organization.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Superintendent Dr. Kwiatkowski provided updates on secondary social studies professional development with Ball State University, Tegen Carpenter<U+2019>s selection as a U.S. Presidential Scholars candidate, ongoing recruitment efforts and training for substitute teachers, and the South Side Middle School robotics team ranking first in the VEX IQ league under advisor Brian Jerome.

- The consent agenda<U+2014>highlighting substantial personal hygiene product donations valued at \$2,960 for South Side and a \$1,500 cash donation from Walmart<U+2014>was approved.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion and voice vote. *(Exact adjournment time not explicitly stated).*
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